MODULE 10

Communication Nation

"Write to be understood, speak to be heard, read to grow."

— LAWRENCE CLARK POWELL

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What forms can communication take?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**The History of Communication**	· illus. Danny Schlitz	INFORMATIONAL TEXT
2	**A New Language—Invented by Kids!**	· Charnan Simon	NARRATIVE NONFICTION
3	**Dolphin Dinner**	· National Geographic Kids	INFORMATIONAL VIDEO
4	**Cooper's Lesson**	· Sun Yung Shin (illus. Kim Cogan)	REALISTIC FICTION

CONTENTS

A · Vocabulary (24) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 5

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 11

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 14

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 10 · Communication Nation · Grade 4 · 24 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

publication

A **publication** is —

- ◯ **A.** a short program or speech on the radio.
- ◯ **B.** something that has been printed and made available for sale.
- ◯ **C.** a private letter you send to one pen pal.
- ◯ **D.** a website where you post informal updates.

Q2 L.4.6

broadcast

A **broadcast** is —

- ◯ **A.** a printed newspaper sold at a store.
- ◯ **B.** an email exchanged with a faraway friend.
- ◯ **C.** a program or speech on the television or radio.
- ◯ **D.** a set of dots and dashes tapped over a wire.

Q3 L.4.6

correspond

When you **correspond** with someone, you —

- ◯ **A.** exchange letters or emails with that person.
- ◯ **B.** read a magazine that person has published.
- ◯ **C.** listen to that person speak on a broadcast.
- ◯ **D.** agree with everything that person believes.

Q4 L.4.6

blog

If you write a **blog**, you are —

- ◯ **A.** printing a book to sell in stores.
- ◯ **B.** reading the news aloud on the radio.
- ◯ **C.** mailing a paper letter to a pen pal.
- ◯ **D.** writing regular and informal updates, or entries, on a website.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE HISTORY OF COMMUNICATION

Q5 L.4.4

significantly

The printing press **significantly** increased the number of books. If something changes **significantly**, the change is —

- ◯ **A.** so small that no one can notice it.
- ◯ **B.** slow and happening over many years.
- ◯ **C.** great enough to be noticed or important.
- ◯ **D.** always a change for the worse.

Q6 L.4.5 TRAP

enabled

The press has **enabled** millions of people to receive knowledge. If you are **enabled** to do something, you are —

- ◯ **A.** given a chance to do it.
- ◯ **B.** forbidden from ever doing it.
- ◯ **C.** forced to do it against your will.
- ◯ **D.** too tired to do it at all.

Q7 L.4.4

patent

Samuel Morse received a **patent** for the telegraph. If you have a **patent** for an invention, you have —

- ◯ **A.** a written plan showing how to build it.
- ◯ **B.** permission from a friend to borrow it.
- ◯ **C.** an award given for a great idea.
- ◯ **D.** a legal document stating you are the only one allowed to make or sell it.

Q8 L.4.4

peak

Radio reached its **peak** of popularity before television. A **peak** can mean the top of a mountain, but it can also mean —

- **A.** the bottom or lowest point of something.
- **B.** the top level or highest degree of something.
- **C.** a slow and steady rise over time.
- **D.** the middle point between two ends.

Q9 L.4.4

transmitted

Marconi's equipment **transmitted** a voice by radio. If something is **transmitted**, it is —

- **A.** sent electronically from one place to another.
- **B.** kept stored in one place and never moved.
- **C.** written down by hand on paper.
- **D.** carried slowly by a person on foot.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE HISTORY OF COMMUNICATION (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.4.4

plucked

Watson **plucked** the reed to loosen it. If something is **plucked**, it is —

- **A.** left exactly where it was.
- **B.** pressed down harder into place.
- **C.** tied tightly so it cannot move.
- **D.** pulled away from where it is.

Q11 L.4.5 TRAP

proposed

An inventor **proposed** a new idea about electric current. If you **proposed** an idea, you —

- **A.** kept it completely secret from everyone.
- **B.** suggested that it was useful or true.
- **C.** proved it was wrong and threw it away.
- **D.** copied it from someone else without asking.

Q12 L.4.4

influence

Television began to **influence** people's lives. If you **influence** people, you —

- **A.** copy exactly what they do and think.
- **B.** obey whatever they tell you to do.
- **C.** use your power to change what they do or think.
- **D.** keep them from changing in any way.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · A NEW LANGUAGE—INVENTED BY KIDS!

Q13 L.4.5 TRAP

astonishment

The grownups watched in **astonishment**. If you look at something with **astonishment**, you feel —

- **A.** bored and sleepy about it.
- **B.** calm and unsurprised by it.
- **C.** angry and upset about it.
- **D.** very surprised by it.

Q14 L.4.4

gestures

The children spoke with hand **gestures**. If you make **gestures**, you make —

- **A.** spoken words with your voice.
- **B.** movements with your hands or arms to share a message.
- **C.** written marks with a pen.
- **D.** faces that hide what you feel.

Q15 L.4.4

linguists

Linguists from around the world studied the new language. **Linguists** are —

- **A.** people who speak several languages and/or study how languages work.
- **B.** people who teach young children to read.
- **C.** people who translate one language out loud for another.
- **D.** people who write stories for a newspaper.

Q16 L.4.5 TRAP

instinct

Humans have a natural **instinct** for language. An **instinct** is something you —

- ◯ **A.** can only learn from a long book.
- ◯ **B.** must be carefully taught by a teacher.
- ◯ **C.** do or know naturally, without being taught.
- ◯ **D.** forget the moment you are born.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · DOLPHIN DINNER

Q17 L.4.4

practical

Working as a team is a **practical** way for dolphins to hunt. If something is **practical**, it —

- ◯ **A.** is useless and a waste of time.
- ◯ **B.** has a useful purpose.
- ◯ **C.** is pretty to look at but does no work.
- ◯ **D.** is difficult and rarely works at all.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · DOLPHIN DINNER (CONTINUED)

Q18 L.4.4

operation

The dolphins' hunt is a smooth **operation**. An **operation** is —

- ◯ **A.** a single action done just once by accident.
- ◯ **B.** a sudden mistake that ruins a plan.
- ◯ **C.** a rest taken after the work is finished.
- ◯ **D.** a set of actions that are carried out to meet a goal.

Q19 L.4.5 TRAP

immaculate

The dolphins' teamwork is nearly **immaculate**. Something that is **immaculate** has —

- ◯ **A.** a few small errors in it.
- ◯ **B.** many mistakes and faults.
- ◯ **C.** no mistakes or faults.
- ◯ **D.** only one small flaw left to fix.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · COOPER'S LESSON

Q20 L.4.4

inspect

Shoppers **inspect** the vegetables before buying them. If you **inspect** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** look at it carefully to judge its quality.
- ◯ **B.** glance at it quickly without thinking.
- ◯ **C.** grab it and pay without a second look.
- ◯ **D.** clean it until it shines.

Q21 L.4.4

liveliest

The shoppers search for the **liveliest** vegetables. The **liveliest** person or animal is the one that is —

- ◯ **A.** the quietest and most still.
- ◯ **B.** the most tired and worn out.
- ◯ **C.** the most active or full of energy.
- ◯ **D.** the calmest and most gentle.

Q22 L.4.5 TRAP

stammered

"Hello," Cooper **stammered**, blushing. If you **stammered**, you —

- ◯ **A.** spoke with many pauses and repeated words.
- ◯ **B.** spoke smoothly and clearly without stopping.
- ◯ **C.** stayed completely silent the whole time.
- ◯ **D.** sang the words in a loud voice.

Q23 L.4.4

expectantly

Mr. Lee looked at Cooper **expectantly**. If you do something **expectantly**, you do it —

- ◯ **A.** without caring what happens next.
- ◯ **B.** while still half asleep.
- ◯ **C.** wishing it were already over.
- ◯ **D.** thinking something is about to happen.

Q24 L.4.5 TRAP

demonstrated

Mr. Lee **demonstrated** how to place the cans on the shelves. If you **demonstrated** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** kept it hidden so no one could see.
- ◯ **B.** showed how it is used or done.
- ◯ **C.** forgot how it was done.
- ◯ **D.** asked someone else to explain it.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 10 · Communication Nation · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3 · RI.4.5 · RI.4.6 · RI.4.8 · RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3 · RL.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · The History of Communication

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · ILLUS. DANNY SCHLITZ · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.4.2

What is "The History of Communication" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How deaf children invented a new sign language.
- ◯ **B.** How dolphins work as a team to catch fish.
- ◯ **C.** How communication has changed over time as new inventions were created.
- ◯ **D.** How a boy learns to speak Korean at a grocery store.

Q2 RI.4.5

How does the author organize the information in this text?

- ◯ **A.** In chronological order, showing inventions from earliest to most recent.
- ◯ **B.** By listing each invention's price from cheapest to most costly.
- ◯ **C.** By comparing two inventors who disagree.
- ◯ **D.** By telling a made-up story with talking animals.

Q3 RI.4.3

According to the text, why was the printing press so important?

- ◯ **A.** It allowed people to talk on the telephone.
- ◯ **B.** It sent messages in Morse code over wires.
- ◯ **C.** It let people watch important events on a screen.
- ◯ **D.** It enabled millions of people to receive knowledge through printed books and newspapers.

Q4 RI.4.3

How did the telegraph send messages over long distances?

- ◯ **A.** By mailing letters on a fast ship.
- ◯ **B.** By tapping out messages in Morse code, a system of dots and dashes, over wires.
- ◯ **C.** By speaking aloud into a telephone.
- ◯ **D.** By showing pictures on a television screen.

Q5 RI.4.3

What did the invention of the telephone make possible?

- ◯ **A.** People could store information on a computer.
- ◯ **B.** People no longer had to be in the same room to talk to one another.
- ◯ **C.** People could watch events on a screen at home.
- ◯ **D.** People could print thousands of newspapers each hour.

Q6 RI.4.1

The text says that television "brought people together to witness important events." What does this mean?

- ◯ **A.** Television made people forget the news.
- ◯ **B.** People had to travel far to see any news.
- ◯ **C.** Only one person at a time could watch.
- ◯ **D.** Many people could see the same important events as they happened.

Q7 RI.4.5

The text includes a timeline of communication technology. How does the timeline help the reader?

- ◯ **A.** It shows when each invention became popular and in what order.
- ◯ **B.** It gives the price of each invention.
- ◯ **C.** It explains how to build each device step by step.
- ◯ **D.** It ranks the inventions from best to worst.

Q8 RI.4.2

Which sentence best states a CENTRAL IDEA of the text?

- ◯ **A.** The printed newspaper has always been the one true way to share news with people.
- ◯ **B.** The telephone was a mistake, and people were better off before it was ever invented.
- ◯ **C.** Over time, each new invention has changed and improved the way people communicate.
- ◯ **D.** People who lived long ago did not really care about communicating with one another.

Selection 2 · A New Language—Invented by Kids!

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · CHARNAN SIMON · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.4.2

What is "A New Language—Invented by Kids!" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How deaf children in Nicaragua invented a brand-new sign language of their own.
- ◯ **B.** How a boy slowly learns about his Korean heritage.
- ◯ **C.** How dusky dolphins hunt together for their dinner.
- ◯ **D.** How the telephone and telegraph were first invented.

Q10 RI.4.3

What happened in 1979 that brought the deaf children together?

- ◯ **A.** A famous teacher arrived to teach them English.
- ◯ **B.** The Nicaraguan government set up two schools for them.
- ◯ **C.** The children were sent to live in the United States.
- ◯ **D.** Their families taught them an old sign language.

Q11 RI.4.3

How did the children's sign language change as new students arrived at the school?

- ◯ **A.** It stayed exactly the same as it was on the first day.
- ◯ **B.** It was slowly replaced by spoken Spanish.
- ◯ **C.** Younger children learned from older students and added new signs, so it became richer and more complex.
- ◯ **D.** It disappeared once the oldest students left the school.

Q12 RI.4.8

What evidence in the text supports the idea that humans have a natural instinct for language?

- ◯ **A.** The children invented a complete new language on their own, with no one teaching it to them.
- ◯ **B.** Adults patiently taught the children every single sign they would ever use.
- ◯ **C.** The children copied their whole language out of an old textbook.
- ◯ **D.** The children refused to communicate with anyone at all.

Q13 RI.4.5

In the part about the schools, the author uses a problem-and-solution text structure. What is the PROBLEM?

- ◯ **A.** The school did not have enough room for all the students.
- ◯ **B.** The children already knew too many languages to choose from.
- ◯ **C.** The teachers were teaching the lessons far too slowly.
- ◯ **D.** When the children arrived, they could not understand their teachers or communicate.

Q14 RI.4.6

What is the author's main purpose for writing this text?

- ◯ **A.** To teach readers how to draw and sketch pictures.
- ◯ **B.** To convince readers to buy sign-language books.
- ◯ **C.** To inform readers about the true story of how Nicaraguan children invented a new language.
- ◯ **D.** To describe stories from the author's own childhood.

Q15 RI.4.2

Which sentence best states a CENTRAL IDEA of "A New Language—Invented by Kids!"?

- ◯ **A.** Sign language is exactly the same in every country all over the world.
- ◯ **B.** Language is a natural human instinct, and even children, given the need, can invent a complete new language.
- ◯ **C.** Only grown-up teachers are able to create a brand-new language.
- ◯ **D.** The children at the schools never managed to understand one another.

Q16 RI.4.1

What can the reader tell about Nicaraguan Sign Language today?

- ◯ **A.** It is an officially recognized language, unlike any other sign language in the world.
- ◯ **B.** It is now exactly the same as American Sign Language, or ASL.
- ◯ **C.** It was invented by the teachers, not by the children themselves.
- ◯ **D.** It is no longer used or remembered by anyone today.

Selection 3 · Dolphin Dinner

INFORMATIONAL VIDEO · NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC KIDS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.4.2

What is the central idea of the video "Dolphin Dinner"?

- ◯ **A.** Each dolphin lives alone and never shares its food with others.
- ◯ **B.** Dusky dolphins work as a team to find and secure their food.
- ◯ **C.** Dolphins are afraid of the deep ocean and stay near the shore.
- ◯ **D.** Dolphins eat only plants that float on the water.

Q18 RI.4.3

According to the video, what are two jobs that dolphins take on when hunting?

- ◯ **A.** Some dolphins rest near the surface while others sleep below.
- ◯ **B.** Some dolphins chase the fish away while others hide.
- ◯ **C.** Some dolphins scout for food in teams, and others herd the fish.
- ◯ **D.** Some dolphins guard the shore while others stay still.

Q19 RI.4.3

Why do the dolphins send signals to one another?

- ◯ **A.** To herd the fish or to signal for more help.
- ◯ **B.** To tell each other to swim away from the food.
- ◯ **C.** To warn the fish that the dolphins are coming.
- ◯ **D.** To play a chasing game with the fish for fun.

Q20 RI.4.5

How is the video organized?

- ◯ **A.** As a random list of facts that are in no particular order.
- ◯ **B.** By comparing two completely different kinds of oceans.
- ◯ **C.** Backward, telling the story from the end to the beginning.
- ◯ **D.** In chronological order, showing how the dolphins find their food in the order it happens.

Q21 RI.4.6

What is the narrator's main purpose in this video?

- ◯ **A.** To explain how dolphins communicate and work together to catch their food.
- ◯ **B.** To make viewers laugh with silly jokes about the sea.
- ◯ **C.** To persuade viewers to buy tickets to an aquarium.
- ◯ **D.** To teach viewers how to swim in the ocean.

Q22 RI.4.5

Which media techniques does the video use to share information?

- ◯ **A.** Only a printed page of words with no pictures.
- ◯ **B.** A single still photograph shown the whole time.
- ◯ **C.** Sound, voice-over narration, and live-action footage.
- ◯ **D.** A hand-drawn cartoon played with no sound at all.

Q23 RI.4.8

What evidence shows that the dolphins use teamwork to hunt?

- ◯ **A.** Each dolphin hunts completely alone and keeps its catch to itself.
- ◯ **B.** Groups of dolphins scout out the food, guide fish to the surface, and signal for more help.
- ◯ **C.** The dolphins ignore one another and swim off in different directions.
- ◯ **D.** The dolphins simply wait for people in boats to feed them.

Q24 RI.4.2

What is one important idea a viewer can learn from "Dolphin Dinner"?

- **A.** Wild animals never need to work together to survive in nature.
- **B.** Dolphins cannot communicate or send any signals at all.
- **C.** Only human beings are able to use teamwork to reach a goal.
- **D.** Animals can communicate, and dusky dolphins use teamwork and signals to catch their food.

Selection 4 · Cooper's Lesson

REALISTIC FICTION · SUN YUNG SHIN (ILLUS. KIM COGAN) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.4.2

What is "Cooper's Lesson" mostly about?

- **A.** A group of dusky dolphins working together to hunt for fish.
- **B.** A scientist who works for years to invent the telephone.
- **C.** A Korean-American boy who feels uneasy about his heritage and slowly connects with a store owner who helps him learn Korean.
- **D.** A group of deaf children who invent a brand-new sign language.

Q26 RL.4.3

Why does Cooper feel uncomfortable at Mr. Lee's store at the start of the story?

- **A.** His mom insists on speaking only Korean to Mr. Lee, even though Cooper can barely follow along.
- **B.** The store is always closed by the time he gets there.
- **C.** Mr. Lee does not sell any of the snacks he likes.
- **D.** The store is far from his home and hard to reach.

Q27 RL.4.3

Why does Cooper go to Mr. Lee's store with his allowance?

- **A.** To buy a brand-new toy for himself with his savings.
- **B.** To replace his mother's hairbrush, which he had ruined while brushing his dog.
- **C.** To return a hairbrush he had borrowed from the store.
- **D.** To meet up with a friend from his school.

Q28 RL.4.1

When the story says Cooper's "tongue lay as heavy and still in his mouth as a dead fish," what does this tell the reader?

- **A.** Cooper is singing a song happily to himself.
- **B.** Cooper is shouting as loudly as he can.
- **C.** Cooper is chatting easily with Mr. Lee.
- **D.** Cooper feels unable to speak, especially in Korean.

Q29 RL.4.3

How does Mr. Lee help Cooper when he demonstrates how to place the cans on the shelves?

- **A.** He tells Cooper the directions twice—first in Korean and then in English.
- **B.** He scolds Cooper for not already knowing Korean.
- **C.** He does the whole job himself and ignores Cooper.
- **D.** He hands Cooper a written list and walks away.

Q30 RL.4.6

"Cooper's Lesson" is told from the third-person point of view. Which detail shows this?

- **A.** Cooper tells the story himself using the word *I* throughout.
- **B.** The reader is spoken to directly with the word *you*.
- **C.** Mr. Lee narrates the events using the word *we*.
- **D.** The narrator uses words such as *he*, *his*, and *Cooper* to tell what Cooper does and feels.

Q31 RL.4.3

Why is it important that Mr. Lee gives Cooper the chance to hear words in both Korean and English?

- **A.** So Cooper will feel embarrassed and leave the store.
- **B.** So Cooper will forget the English words he already knows.
- **C.** It makes it easier for Cooper to learn to understand and speak Korean.
- **D.** So Cooper will stop visiting the store for good.

Q32 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the main THEME, or lesson, of "Cooper's Lesson"?

- **A.** Cooper takes his dog Catso for a walk.
- **B.** Communication is more than language; patience, effort, and connecting across a language barrier help Cooper understand Mr. Lee and his own heritage.
- **C.** Cooper's mom asks him to buy ginger.
- **D.** A poster for a new Tae Kwon Do gym hangs in the window.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 10 · Communication Nation · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about the forms communication can take. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Change DOK 3

In **"The History of Communication,"** the way people share messages has changed over time. Show one EARLY way and one LATER way people communicated, then explain how communication changed.

HOW COMMUNICATION CHANGED OVER TIME · THE HISTORY OF COMMUNICATION

AN EARLY WAY	A LATER WAY	WHAT CHANGED

The text shows inventions from the printing press and telegraph to the telephone, radio, television, and the World Wide Web. Why does each new invention build on the ones before it? Use the word *change* in your answer.

Q2 Innovation DOK 3

In **"A New Language—Invented by Kids!,"** deaf children in Nicaragua created a brand-new language. Show WHAT problem the children faced, then explain HOW they solved it.

INVENTING A NEW LANGUAGE · A NEW LANGUAGE—INVENTED BY KIDS!

THE PROBLEM	WHAT THEY DID	THE RESULT
what could the children not do?	*how did they communicate?*	*what did they create?*

The text says humans have a natural instinct for language. Why is it amazing that children, with no one teaching them, invented a complete new language? Explain.

Q3 Connection DOK 3

In **"Dolphin Dinner,"** dolphins work together to catch their food. Compare what ONE dolphin could do ALONE with what dolphins do as a TEAM, then explain the lesson.

COMMUNICATING AS A TEAM · DOLPHIN DINNER

A DOLPHIN ALONE	DOLPHINS AS A TEAM

The video shows that dolphins scout, herd fish, and send signals to one another. Why does communicating and working together help the dolphins more than hunting alone? Explain.

Q4 Connection DOK 3

In **"Cooper's Lesson,"** Cooper feels he cannot communicate with Mr. Lee at first, but this changes. Show how Cooper feels at the START and at the END, then explain the lesson.

CONNECTING ACROSS A LANGUAGE · COOPER'S LESSON

COOPER AT THE START	COOPER AT THE END

Mr. Lee patiently speaks to Cooper in both Korean and English. Why is communication more than just knowing the words of a language? Use the word *connection* in your answer.

Q5 Inquiry DOK 4

Essential Question: What forms can communication take? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What form of communication does this selection show?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What form of communication does this selection show?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 10 · Communication Nation · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Talking Drums

Long ago, in parts of West Africa, people had a clever way to send news across long distances. They did not have phones or radios. Instead, they used special drums. These drums were called "talking drums." A skilled drummer could change the sound of the drum to copy the rises and falls of the human voice. By beating the drum in different ways, the drummer could send words, not just music. A message could travel from one village to the next when a drummer heard it and then beat it out again on his own drum. In this way, news passed from village to village much faster than a person could walk or run. People used talking drums to share important news. They told of births, weddings, and dangers. They even called people together for meetings. The sound of the drums could travel for miles on a quiet day. Long before telephones were invented, the talking drums helped people stay connected. They show that humans have always found ways to send messages to one another, even with simple tools.

179 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1 RIT 200 · Lexile 500L · Key Detail

What did people in parts of West Africa use to send news long ago?

- ◯ **A.** Letters carried from village to village by ship.
- ◯ **B.** Special drums called "talking drums."
- ◯ **C.** Telephones and radios in every home.
- ◯ **D.** Bright flashing lights sent across the hills.

Q2 RIT 202 · Lexile 520L · Key Detail

How could a drummer send words and not just music?

- ◯ **A.** By singing the words aloud along with the drum.
- ◯ **B.** By carving the words into the side of the drum.
- ◯ **C.** By beating the drum as loudly as possible.
- ◯ **D.** By changing the sound of the drum to copy the rises and falls of the human voice.

Q3 RIT 203 · Lexile 530L · Cause & Effect

Why could a message travel quickly from one village to the next?

- ◯ **A.** A drummer in the next village heard the message and beat it out again on his own drum.
- ◯ **B.** A fast runner carried the heavy drum from one place to the next.
- ◯ **C.** The strong wind blew the drum's sound all the way across the land.
- ◯ **D.** All of the villages happened to be built very close together.

Q4 RIT 205 · Lexile 550L · Key Detail

What kinds of news did people share with the talking drums?

- ◯ **A.** Only a report of the weather, given each morning.
- ◯ **B.** Only the names of the most skilled drummers.
- ◯ **C.** Births, weddings, and dangers, and they called people together for meetings.
- ◯ **D.** Only cheerful songs that were used for dancing.

Q5 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Main Idea

What is this passage MOSTLY about?

- ◯ **A.** The step-by-step way to carve and build a wooden drum.
- ◯ **B.** How people used talking drums to send messages across long distances before telephones.
- ◯ **C.** The many ways that drums are used in music today.
- ◯ **D.** How small villages slowly grew larger over many years.

Passage 2 · The Bees' Dance

Honeybees cannot talk the way people do, but they still share important news with one another. When a worker bee finds a patch of flowers full of sweet nectar, she flies back to the hive. Inside the dark hive, she cannot simply tell the others where the food is. Instead, she does a special dance. Scientists call it the "waggle dance." The bee moves in a path shaped like the number eight and shakes, or waggles, her body as she goes. The direction of her dance tells the other bees which way to fly to reach the flowers. The length of her waggle tells them how far away the food is. A short waggle means the flowers are close. A long waggle means they are far. The other bees gather around and feel the movements in the dark. Then they fly out to find the flowers themselves. In this way, one bee can send a clear message to many bees without making a sound. The waggle dance is one of nature's most amazing forms of communication, and it helps the whole hive find enough food to survive.

187 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Key Detail

What does a worker bee do when she finds flowers full of nectar?

- **A.** She stays at the flowers and eats by herself all day.
- **B.** She leads the other bees back to the flowers right away.
- **C.** She flies back to the hive and does a special dance.
- **D.** She quietly hides the flowers so no other bee finds them.

Q7 RIT 208 · Lexile 580L · Key Detail

What does the direction of the bee's dance tell the other bees?

- **A.** Which way to fly to reach the flowers.
- **B.** How far away the flowers are.
- **C.** What color the flowers are.
- **D.** How many flowers are waiting.

Q8 RIT 209 · Lexile 590L · Cause & Effect

Why does the bee need to dance instead of just telling the others where the food is?

- **A.** Because all of the other bees are fast asleep in the hive.
- **B.** Because the patch of flowers keeps moving from place to place.
- **C.** Because she herself does not really know the way back.
- **D.** Because inside the dark hive she cannot simply tell the others where the food is.

Q9 RIT 210 · Lexile 600L · Vocabulary

The passage says the bee "shakes, or waggles, her body." In this sentence, **waggles** means —

- **A.** stays perfectly still and does not move.
- **B.** moves quickly back and forth.
- **C.** floats slowly and gently in one spot.
- **D.** flies far away from the hive.

Q10 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Main Idea

What is the main idea of "The Bees' Dance"?

- **A.** Bees mostly like to dance together just for fun.
- **B.** Flowers with sweet nectar grow best in the summer.
- **C.** The inside of a honeybee hive is always very dark.
- **D.** Honeybees use a special dance to share important information without making a sound.

Passage 3 · How Mail Travels Today

Have you ever wondered what happens to a letter after you drop it into a mailbox? Its journey is just beginning. First, a mail carrier collects the letter and takes it to a post office. There, machines and workers sort the mail. A machine reads the address and zip code printed on the envelope. The zip code is a special set of numbers that tells the machine which part of the country the letter must go to. The letters are then grouped by where they are headed. Next, the mail is loaded onto trucks, and sometimes onto planes, to travel to faraway places. A letter sent across the country might fly thousands of miles in a single day. When the mail reaches the right city, it goes to a local post office. There, it is sorted one more time, by street and house number. Finally, a mail carrier picks up the letter and delivers it right to the correct mailbox. What once took weeks by ship long ago can now cross the whole country in just a few days. The mail system is a careful, step-by-step operation that helps millions of people stay in touch.

195 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 211–216

Q11 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

What is the FIRST thing that happens to a letter after it goes into the mailbox?

- ◯ **A.** A mail carrier collects it and takes it to a post office.
- ◯ **B.** It is loaded onto a truck or a plane to travel far.
- ◯ **C.** It is sorted by its street and house number.
- ◯ **D.** It is delivered straight to the correct house.

Q12 RIT 212 · Lexile 640L · Key Detail

What does the zip code on an envelope do?

- ◯ **A.** It tells the carrier the name of the writer.
- ◯ **B.** It shows how much the whole letter weighs.
- ◯ **C.** It tells the machine which part of the country the letter must go to.
- ◯ **D.** It tells the carrier the price of the stamp.

Q13 RIT 213 · Lexile 660L · Sequence

After the mail reaches the right city, what happens next?

- ◯ **A.** It is loaded back onto a plane and flown to another city.
- ◯ **B.** It goes to a local post office and is sorted by street and house number.
- ◯ **C.** It is mailed all the way back to where it first started.
- ◯ **D.** A machine reads the zip code for the very first time.

Q14 RIT 215 · Lexile 680L · Vocabulary

The passage calls the mail system a "step-by-step **operation**." In this sentence, **operation** means —

- ◯ **A.** a kind of medical surgery in a hospital.
- ◯ **B.** a single quick action done only once.
- ◯ **C.** a large machine with many moving parts.
- ◯ **D.** a set of actions carried out to reach a goal.

Q15 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "How Mail Travels Today"?

- ◯ **A.** Planes are always much faster than mail trucks.
- ◯ **B.** Mailboxes today come in many different colors.
- ◯ **C.** The mail system is a careful, step-by-step process that helps people stay in touch across long distances.
- ◯ **D.** A letter weighs much more than a small postcard.

Passage 4 · The Boy Who Listened

In a small mountain town, there lived a boy named Mateo whose grandfather had grown up speaking an old language that few people still used. When Mateo was little, he understood only a few words of it. His friends at school spoke another language, and Mateo wanted to fit in, so he ignored his grandfather's words. As the years passed, the old man grew quiet. One winter, Mateo's grandfather fell ill. Sitting by his bed, Mateo realized how little they had truly spoken. He wished he could tell his grandfather how much he loved him in the old words. So Mateo began to ask his grandfather to teach him, a little each day. At first the sounds felt strange and clumsy on his tongue, and Mateo stammered. But his grandfather smiled and repeated each word slowly, first in the old language and then in the new. Bit by bit, Mateo learned. By spring, the two could talk for hours, laughing and sharing stories of the past. Mateo learned that a language is more than words; it is a bridge between people. By listening and trying, he had found his way back to his grandfather and to a part of himself.

200 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Key Detail

Why does Mateo ignore his grandfather's words when he is little?

- ◯ **A.** He cannot hear his grandfather very well.
- ◯ **B.** He does not like spending time with his grandfather.
- ◯ **C.** His grandfather always speaks far too loudly.
- ◯ **D.** His friends speak another language, and he wants to fit in.

Q17 RIT 217 · Lexile 720L · Cause & Effect

What makes Mateo decide to learn the old language?

- ◯ **A.** A teacher at his school gives him a hard test on it.
- ◯ **B.** His grandfather falls ill, and Mateo realizes how little they had truly spoken.
- ◯ **C.** His family suddenly moves to a brand-new town.
- ◯ **D.** He finds an old book about the language in the attic.

Q18 RIT 218 | Lexile 740L | Vocabulary

The story says the sounds "felt strange and clumsy on his tongue, and Mateo **stammered**." The word **stammered** means he —

- ◯ **A.** spoke with many pauses and repeated words.
- ◯ **B.** spoke smoothly and clearly with no trouble.
- ◯ **C.** shouted the words as loudly as he could.
- ◯ **D.** refused to say anything to anyone at all.

Q19 RIT 219 | Lexile 770L | Cause & Effect

How is Mateo able to learn the old language, little by little?

- ◯ **A.** He studies it all alone from an old book in the attic.
- ◯ **B.** He manages to learn the whole language in a single afternoon.
- ◯ **C.** His grandfather repeats each word slowly, first in the old language and then in the new.
- ◯ **D.** He gives up after a few days and never really learns it.

Q20 RIT 220 | Lexile 800L | Main Idea

What is the lesson, or theme, of this story?

- ◯ **A.** A language is more than words; by listening and trying, we can build a bridge to the people we love.
- ◯ **B.** An old language is simply too hard for a young person to learn.
- ◯ **C.** Winters up in the mountains can be very long and very cold.
- ◯ **D.** Grandparents always know best, so children should simply obey them.